

The hour Indian athletics reimagined what was possible

Three marks once considered impossible to breach in Indian athletics — a 10.09-second 100m, a sub-45-second 400m and an 8000-point decathlon — were achieved within perhaps the most **remarkable hour** in the history of a domestic track and field meet.

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There have been days in domestic competition in Indian track and field when talent has burst through. There have been days when national records have been set and broken. There has rarely been a day like Saturday, May 23, 2026, when it seemed the very ceiling of what was once considered

possible in Indian sport had been lifted. Within the space of a near-surreal hour, three of the defining landmarks of track and field were crossed. It offered a tantalising glimpse of how far Indian athletics has come, and how much further it might go. At 7.10 pm, Gurindervir Singh stormed to a 10.09-second finish in the 100m to become the fastest Indian of all time. Half an hour later, Vishal TK

Lightning run: Sprinter Gurindervir Singh clocked 10.09 seconds in the men's 100m at the National Senior Federation Competition in Ranchi, breaking the national record at the Birsu Munda Football Stadium.

Pics: RITU RAJ KONWAR

